

Mike Zhen

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Capital One

McLean, VA

Senior Lead Software Engineer

Jul 2024 - Present

- Spearheaded 0→1 observability initiative across multiple domains, architecting cloud-native data ingestion pipelines in AWS from 15+ enterprise sources to establish a unified telemetry foundation — accelerating incident resolution and building technical use cases for enterprise-wide observability adoption
- Served as architecture advisor for 5-8 engineering teams, conducting reviews for distributed systems and event-driven architectures to surface non-functional requirements and resolve complex technical blockers
- Established architectural coaching practice for engineers across partner integration workstreams, accelerating delivery cadence while upholding design quality standards

Lead Software Engineer

Jul 2021 - Jul 2024

- Led a cross-functional team of engineers in the design and delivery of a secure external-facing web portal built on React and Java, enabling 10+ co-brand partners to access contractual reporting and analytics
- Architected and implemented a scalable group-based authorization model in AWS utilizing SSO to enforce strict multi-tenant data isolation across all external partners — eliminating unauthorized data access risk
- Drove engineering excellence across the team through code reviews and technical workshops in cloud-native and modern web patterns — reducing review cycle times and improving codebase maintainability

Senior Software Engineer

Dec 2018 - Jul 2021

- Engineered a high-concurrency serverless data pipeline to process 20M+ customer records daily into a mission-critical Stand-In Processing (STIP) database, ensuring data availability for authorization decisions
- Design and implement end-to-end identity verification features for agent servicing platform using Kotlin and Angular, while partnering closely with product and business stakeholders to ensure rapid refinement based on evolving AML regulatory requirements
- Built high-performance internal services using Golang and Docker to aggregate data across fragmented enterprise silos, enabling centralized architecture analytics for strategic planning decisions by leadership

Software Engineer

Jul 2016 - Dec 2018

- Partnered with cloud architect to design comprehensive migration plans for 8 vendor applications, ensuring seamless cloud migration into AWS and achieving overall reduction in recovery time objectives (RTO)
- Automated end-to-end cloud infrastructure provisioning and application deployment using Jenkins, Terraform, and Ansible, improving deployment time and eliminating manual configuration errors
- Developed custom Python automation to encrypt legacy data-at-rest across multiple AWS services, successfully closing security compliance gaps ahead of native AWS control availability

Associate Software Engineer

Jul 2015 - Jul 2016

- Developed internal MEAN stack web application from inception and hybrid mobile prototype using Ionic, establishing reusable frameworks that cut future project onboarding time

SKILLS

Architecture/Design: Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, Cloud-Native Patterns, API Design

Infrastructure/DevOps: AWS, Terraform, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, CI/CD

Languages: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Java

Frameworks/Data: React, Node.js, Spring Boot, Kafka, PostgreSQL

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Urbana, IL

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering